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INTERIM FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

MOUSETRAP AND RATTRAP, SPRING ACTUATED

This Interim Federal Specification was developed by the Standardization Division, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, Washington, D. C. 20406, based upon currently available technical information. It is recommended that Federal agencies use it in procurement and forward recommendations for changes to the preparing activity at the address shown above.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers mousetraps and rattraps, spring actuated, with four-way tripping action.

1.1.1 Federal specification coverage. Federal specifications do not include all varieties of the commodity as indicated by the title of the specification, or which are commercially available, but are intended to cover only those generally used by the Federal Government.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 Types. Mousetraps and rattraps covered by this specification shall be of the following types, as specified (see 6.2):

Type I. - Mousetrap
Type II. - Rattrap

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following specifications and standards, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids, or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

Federal Specifications:

QQ-W-428 - Wire, Steel, High Carbon, Round, Uncoated for Mechanical Springs (General Purposes).
QQ-W-461 - Wire, Steel, Carbon, (Round, Bare and Coated).
PPP-B-566 - Boxes, Folding, Paperboard.
PPP-B-585 - Boxes, Wood, Wirebound.
PPP-B-591 - Boxes, Fiberboard, Wood-Cleated.
PPP-B-601 - Boxes, Wood, Cleated-Plywood, for Domestic Shipment.
PPP-B-621 - Boxes, Wood, Nailed and Lock Corner.
PPP-B-636 - Boxes, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-640 - Boxes, Fiberboard, Corrugated, Triple, Well.
PPP-B-665 - Boxes, Paperboard, Metal Stayed (Including Stay Material).
PPP-B-676 - Boxes, Set-Up, Paperboard.

Federal Standard:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civilian Agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D. C. 20402.

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(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D. C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Ft. Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, Wash.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Specification:

MIL-P-116 - Preservation, Methods of.

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Design. The mousetrap and rattrap covered by this specification shall be of commercial design and shall be capable of meeting the performance requirements specified herein. The traps shall be spring type, consisting of a wood base on which is mounted a locking bar, bait pedal, spring or springs, and wire bow which projects over the end of the wood base when the trap is sprung. The traps shall be so designed that they will be capable of being tripped from the right or left side of the bait pedal or from the top or underside of the bait pedal.

3.2 Construction. Mousetraps and rattraps shall be complete so they can be used for the purpose intended.

3.3 Wood bases. Wood bases shall be fabricated from straight grained kiln dried Ponderosa, Idaho pine or other woods capable of meeting the performance required herein. Wood bases shall be free from all defects that would affect the serviceability or appearance.

3.3.1 Type I. Wood bases for type I mousetraps shall have minimum dimensions of 3-3/4 inches long by 1-5/8 inches wide by 3/16 inch thick.

3.3.2 Type II. Wood bases for type II rattraps shall have minimum dimensions of 6-3/4 inches long by 3-1/4 inches wide by 1/2 inch thick.

3.4 Wire. Wire material for mousetrap and rattrap springs shall be any type in accordance with QQ-W-428. Wire material for mousetrap and rattrap bows, locking bars, and staples shall be in accordance with QQ-W-461, temper hard, annealed-in process, or annealed, finish 2, 3, or 5. Wire diameters shall be, as specified in table I.

TABLE I. Wire size

	Steel wire gage (U.S.) (minimum diameters)	
Components	Type I - mousetraps	Type II - rattraps
Spring	No. 20 (0.0348)	No. 15 (0.072)
Bow	No. 16 (0.625)	No. 11 (0.1250)
Locking Bar	No. 17 (0.0540)	No. 13 (0.0915)
Staples	No. 18 (0.0475)	No. 15 (0.072)

3.5 Springs. Springs shall be of the helical torsion type.

3.5.1 Type I. Mousetrap springs shall have a minimum of twenty coils and exert a force on the bow of not less than 1-1/2 pounds at 180° (see 4.4.1).

3.5.2 Type II. Rattrap springs shall have a minimum of twenty-two coils and exert a force on the bow of not less than 6 pounds at 180° (see 4.4.1).

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3.6 Bait pedal. Bait pedals for mousetraps and rattraps shall be fabricated from strip steel and shall be finished with a copper, tin, or zinc coating in accordance with the manufacturer's commercial practice.

3.7 Staples. All staples shall be driven through the wood base and clinched on the underside in such a manner as to withstand a minimum pull test of not less than 9 pounds for each mousetrap staple and a minimum of 25 pounds for each rattrap staple (see 4.4.2).

3.8 Bow. The minimum length of the bow for type I mousetraps shall be 1.6 inches from the center of the spring to the center of the bow wire. Type II rattraps shall have a minimum length of 3.1 inches from the center of the spring to the center of the bow wire.

3.9 Identification. Each mousetrap or rattrap shall be plainly marked with the manufacturer's name or trademark of such known character that the source of manufacture may be readily determined.

3.10 Workmanship. Mousetraps and rattraps shall be constructed, assembled, and finished in a thoroughly workmanlike manner to assure good quality and a neat general appearance.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements, as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to the prescribed requirements.

4.2 Sampling for lot acceptance.

4.2.1 Inspection lot. All mousetraps and rattraps offered for delivery at one time shall be considered a lot for the purpose of acceptance, inspection, and test.

4.2.2 Sampling for examination and test. A random sample of mousetraps and rattraps shall be taken by the inspector from each inspection lot of material offered, with lot acceptance based on inspection level S-2 with an acceptable quality level (AQL) of 1.5 percent defective, in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

4.3 Examination. Each of the sample mousetraps or rattraps taken in accordance with 4.2.2 shall be examined for compliance with this specification. Any mousetrap or rattrap in the sample containing one or more defects shall be rejected, and if the number of defective mousetraps or rattraps in any sample lot exceeds the acceptance number for that sample, the lot represented by the sample shall be rejected.

4.4 Tests.

4.4.1 Spring tension test. Each mousetrap or rattrap selected from the lot for testing shall be tested on a precision spring scale. The hook of the scale shall be attached to the center of the bow and the base of the trap restrained. The scale reading shall be observed when the bow is parallel to the base and the direction of pull or push is perpendicular to the base.

4.4.2 Staple test. The hook of the spring scale referenced in 4.4.1 shall be secured to the staple. With the base restrained, a slow steady pull shall be exerted perpendicular to the base. The spring shall be removed prior to testing the staples.

4.5 Rejected lots. Rejected lots may be resubmitted for examination and test, provided the contractor has removed or repaired all nonconforming mousetraps or rattraps. Samples shall again be selected and and inspected from such resubmitted lots to verify compliance with this specification. Rejected mousetraps or rattraps shall not be resubmitted for inspection without furnishing full particulars concerning previous rejections, and measures taken to overcome the defects.

4.6 Inspection of preparation for delivery requirements. An inspection shall be made to determine that the packaging, packing, and marking comply with the requirements in section 5. Defects shall be scored in accordance with table II. For examination of interior packaging, the sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery, selected at random just prior to the closing operations. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. Defects of closure listed shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL shall be 4.0 defects per hundred units.

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TABLE II. Classification of preparation for delivery defects

Examine	Defects
Markings (exterior and interior)	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Materials	Any component missing, or damaged.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as incomplete closure of container flaps, loose strapping, inadequate stapling. Distortion of container.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A.

5.1.1.1 Unit packaging. Twelve traps of like description shall be packaged together in accordance with method IC-2 of MIL-P-116.

5.1.2 Level B.

5.1.2.1 Type I. Twelve type I traps shall be placed in a paperboard box of the type normally used for the item or assembled into a compact package. The package shall be formed in such a manner that the 12 traps will withstand handling and storage without coming apart.

5.1.2.2 Type II. Twelve type II traps shall be packaged together in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class, domestic. The box shall be closed in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.1.3 Level C. The traps shall be packaged in accordance with the suppliers commercial practice.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. Traps of like description furnished in quantities, as specified (see 6.2) shall be packed in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-585, class 3; PPP-B-591, class 2; PPP-B-601, overseas type; PPP-B-621, class 2; PPP-B-636, class, weather-resistant; or PPP-B-640, class 2, grade A. The boxes shall be closed and strapped in accordance with the applicable specification or appendix thereto. The gross weight of the triple wall box or wood boxes shall not exceed 200 pounds. The gross weight of PPP-B-636 box shall not exceed the weight limitations of the box specification.

5.2.2 Level B. Twelve unit packages of traps of like descriptions shall be packed in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic. The box shall be closed in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.2.3 Level C. The traps shall be packed to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination in containers complying with the rules and regulations applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.3 Standard pack (civil agency procurements). The standard pack for civil agency procurement shall be, as specified in paragraphs 5.1.2 and 5.2.2 (see 6.3).

5.4 Marking.

5.4.1 Civil agencies. In addition to markings required by the contract or order (see 6.2), the interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.4.2 Military activities. In addition to markings required by the contract or order (see 6.2), the interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The mousetraps and rattraps covered by this specification are used to trap, hold, or kill rodents of various species.

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6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Type (see 1.2.1).
(c) Level of packaging and packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(d) Quantities in shipping container (see 5.2.1).
(e) Special marking, if required (see 5.4).

6.3 Standard pack for civil agencies. The standard pack requirements in 5.3 are intended for use in procurements of stores stock replenishments. Procuring officers should use the standard pack requirements when it is known that the material will be shipped from a supplier to a domestic warehouse, supply depot, or intermediate storage point for temporary storage, subsequent issue, or shipment to eventual user.

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